

# Lot Evaluation Checklist

Print this and take it to a showing. A parcel being for sale does not make it buildable.

## Access and legal

- ☐ Legal, recorded access to a public road (not a handshake easement)
- ☐ Easements on the title that cross the buildable area
- ☐ Zoning permits a single-family dwelling of the size you want
- ☐ Setbacks, height limit, and lot coverage leave a real building envelope
- ☐ CCRs or HOA design review requirements obtained in writing
- ☐ Any plat notes or conditions of approval reviewed

## Utilities

- ☐ Power: at the property line, or how far away and who pays to extend
- ☐ Water: municipal at the line, or a well is required
- ☐ Sewer: municipal at the line, or a septic system is required
- ☐ Septic feasibility confirmed with Central District Health
- ☐ Natural gas available, or plan for propane or all-electric
- ☐ Internet and phone service available at the address

## Ground conditions

- ☐ Slope across the building envelope, and what it does to excavation
- ☐ Soils: whether a geotechnical report is required
- ☐ Groundwater depth and seasonal high water table
- ☐ Fill on site from prior grading or farming
- ☐ Rock, caliche, or hardpan that changes excavation cost
- ☐ Drainage: where water goes in a spring melt

## Regulatory and environmental

- ☐ FEMA floodplain designation checked
- ☐ Irrigation district ditches, laterals, or delivery obligations
- ☐ Wildland-urban interface requirements if foothills
- ☐ Wetlands or protected features
- ☐ Any recorded agricultural or water rights that transfer

## Cost to build here

| Item                       | Estimated \$ | Confirmed by   |
|----------------------------|--------------|----------------|
| Land purchase              | _____        |                |
| Well                       | _____        | Driller quote  |
| Septic system              | _____        | Designer / CDH |
| Driveway and access        | _____        |                |
| Power extension            | _____        | Utility        |
| Excavation and grading     | _____        | Builder        |
| Impact and connection fees | _____        | Jurisdiction   |

## Before you make an offer

- Make the offer contingent on septic feasibility and a soils review
- Give yourself enough inspection period to get real quotes, not guesses
- A written lot evaluation runs \$950 to \$3,500 and is credited toward design if you build with us
- Lot evaluation: <https://boiseconstruction.co/services/lot-evaluation>
- Land guide: <https://boiseconstruction.co/guides/buying-land-to-build-boise>